Senior management would appreciate any suggestions and ideas that you may have in this regard.

COMMUNICATION AND COOPERATION

I have made this point before, and will make it again. We need to improve channels of communication within the Bank, both horizontally and vertically. The Bank cannot afford to be divided into silos – too much of our work cuts across departmental boundaries. For managers, better communication means more willingness to meet in person or by video conference/phone/email than by interdepartmental memos and file pushing. It means fast responses to the queries that come to your desk, recognizing that cooperation will be amply repaid. It means regular meetings with staff to address their questions.

For staff, it means being willing to ask questions and resolve anxieties when you have face-to-face meetings with managers, rather than be silent at that time and then succumbing to unfounded rumours floated by vested interests who want to prey on your anxieties. It is always fun to concoct conspiracy theories, and we Indians often prefer them to more mundane explanations. However, management in the Bank is open, and one only needs to ask to get the facts.

We also need to communicate better with the outside. This means that we should get ahead of the press, rather than be reactive. If we want to highlight achievements or regulations, we should prepare a press release to focus the press on what is important – with the release getting to the point quickly rather than starting with pages of irrelevant history. Press releases are best done at or before 5.30 pm if you want it to show up in the papers. Beyond that, reporters do not have the time to write copy for the next day, and the news is too old for the day after.